

Nitroglycerin

(Nitro-bid, Nitro-dur)

- I. Classification**
 - Vasodilator
- II. Action(s)**
 - Potent smooth muscle relaxer – dilates arteries and veins
 - Reduces cardiac workload
 - Dilates coronary arteries – improves perfusion of ischemic cardiac muscle
- III. Indication(s)**
 - Chest pain associated with Acute MI or angina pectoris
 - Acute pulmonary edema / CHF exacerbation
- IV. Contraindications**
 - Hypersensitivity
 - Recent (within 24 hours) ingestion of sexual enhancement drugs
 - Hypotension / shock
 - Increased intracranial pressure
- V. Precautions**
 - Do not administer if SBP < 100 (SBP < 120 if right ventricular MI suspected)
 - Blood pressure should be monitored before and after each dose
 - Do not administer nitroglycerin without an IV established (unless specific order by Medical Director)
- VI. Drug interactions**
 - Sexual enhancement medications (Cialis, Viagra, Levitra) – can cause life-threatening hypotension
 - Beta blockers and calcium channel blockers– can cause hypotension
- VII. Adult Dosing and Administration**
 - Chest pain: 0.4 mg SL every 5 minutes until Chest Pain free or SBP <100
 - CHF Exacerbation: 0.4 mg SL every 4 minutes, maintain SBP >110
- VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration**
 - Not routinely indicated in pediatric patients
- IX. Onset**
 - 1 to 3 minutes
- X. Duration**
 - 30 to 60 minutes
- XI. Possible Adverse Effects**
 - Hypotension, bradycardia
 - Headache / dizziness / weakness / dry mouth
 - Nausea / vomiting